

Killer Rigs

Thinking of building a new rig for yourself or have a friend bugging you for rig suggestions? Read on

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Cost-effective tablets



Selecting the best budget tablet under ₹10,000

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At the beginning, circa 2010, budget tablets were, for the lack of a better word, horrible. Why? Well for starters they ran smartphone OSes and the utility you derived from them was zilch. And they were lightyears away from the Apple iPad, the device that ushered in the tablet era.

Fast forward two years and we have a different scenario. The phase of bad first generation tablets has passed; we have tablets that are not only affordable but boast of decent power under the hood. The best part is that these devices run on Google's Android 4.0 ICS, a fully featured tablet-ready OS. The market today is flooded with so many tablets that the average consumer will get confused as to which tablet can do what and is the device a bang for your buck? When you decide to go in for a tablet that costs ₹10,000 or less, there are only two reasons why you will do so. Either you can't afford one or you are testing the waters, if a tablet really makes sense for you. Since you are going

for a budget tablet, please understand that there are quite a few features that it won't have. On the other hand, there are essential features that should absolutely be there so that the device doesn't end up becoming your next expensive paper-weight. Heed these wise words before picking up a sub 10K tablet.

Build Quality

Straight out of the box, don't expect the build quality of the device to be stellar. On the other hand don't expect it to be bad either. The build of most of these tablets revolves around 7-inches except for the Micromax Funbook Pro which has a 10.1-inch display. The material used for these devices is plastic. Most of them have a matte finish which makes the device easier to grip.



iberry auxus ax02

Capacitive display that works

If the display isn't capacitive, don't bother. A resistive display requires a stylus, which will take you back to the stone ages, and some of the lower priced tablets have capacitive displays that are more gimmicky than functional. The likes of the Micromax Funbook, iberry Auxus AX02 and the Zync Z990 Plus have capacitive touchscreens that get the job done quite well. With the exception of a few, all the tablets support a 7-inch display with a resolution of 480x800 and this has become an acceptable standard. Some